

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Matrimonial/Family Legal Assistant role at Davies and Partners because family law is an area where I already have direct client-facing experience, and I want to develop that work further in a dedicated legal support role.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire, I advise clients on family, housing, welfare and debt matters. Many of those clients are going through separations or custody disputes, and my work involves taking detailed factual statements, identifying the legal and evidential issues in their situation, and drafting correspondence and applications while keeping case files up to date. That work has given me a practical understanding of the pressures clients face in family proceedings and how important it is to communicate clearly without oversimplifying. I manage a caseload with competing deadlines, which means maintaining organised records and tracking what needs to happen next across multiple matters at once.

Before that, I spent a year on placement at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, split between International Arbitration and Real Estate Disputes. In the disputes team I prepared hearing bundles, assisted with court filings, managed large volumes of documents across several matters, and coordinated procedural steps under time pressure. In arbitration I was, for a period, the only junior supporting the team before a significant submission deadline, which meant tracking outstanding actions and coordinating document production across an international matter. Both rotations required careful attention to detail, structured file management, and the ability to handle confidential material responsibly.

I am drawn to this role specifically because it would allow me to build on the family law exposure I already have at Citizens Advice, within a firm environment where I can work more closely with qualified solicitors and develop my technical understanding of family proceedings. Davies and Partners has a strong reputation for individual-focused legal services, and working in a team that handles matrimonial matters for real people at difficult points in their lives is exactly the kind of work I want to be doing at this stage of my career.

I hold a 2:1 LLB from UCL and an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution from Queen Mary, and I am available to start immediately.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva